

Delaware County Budget Hearings October 14th 2024

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=wQJQbRXSKEA
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Delaware County Council Budget Work Session Report

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The meeting was called to order by the presiding officers of the Delaware County Council for a budget work session review.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Board Members Present:** Jessica (Presiding/Council Member), Matt (Council Member/Finance Committee), Bill (Council Member/Finance Committee), and other participating council members.
 - **Other County Officials Present:** Ed (Auditor's Office), Fred (Sheriff/Jail Department representatives), Carrie (Highway Department representative), and Tony (Sheriff Department representative).
 - **Members Absent:** Not explicitly stated.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** None recorded.
- **Approval of Minutes:** None recorded.

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:00:35 Budget Review & Longevity Corrections Discussion**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jessica and Matt (Finance Committee).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The board discussed findings from a recent visit to the auditor's office and consultation with the State Board of Accounts (SBOA) regarding longevity pay. It was determined that the previous method of building longevity (specifically the 62.2% longevity and public safety experience matrices) into base salaries was handled incorrectly under state accounting guidelines. Base salaries must be uniform for identical job classifications, and longevity or experience pay must be separated into distinct line items. Furthermore, establishing a new public safety experience matrix or longevity plan requires a formal ordinance, a public hearing process, updates to the employee handbook by the Commissioners, and an actuarial study to ensure fiscal sustainability, as past longevity plans have historically been rescinded or unsustainable.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Consensus to table formal longevity ordinance decisions for public safety and defer final structural adjustments to subsequent work sessions. Base salaries for affected departments (911/Communications, Sheriff/Jail) are to be adjusted down to baseline levels, with experience amounts moved to separate tracking lines or handled via future appropriations and major transfers.
- **00:18:36 Departmental Budget & Line Item Adjustments (Prosecutor, Communications, Highway/MVH, and County General)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Elizabeth, Jessica, Matt, and departmental representatives.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The council went line-by-line through proposed adjustments for the Prosecutor's office, Communications Center (911), Motor Vehicle Highway (MVH), Bridge, and County General funds. Discussions centered on aligning non-employee operational expenses back to 2024 baseline numbers (reversing general 10% inflation bumps), leveling base salaries for equipment operators, truck drivers, mechanics, welders, and garage foremen, and correcting associated FICA and PERF calculations. Additional revenue projections from jail operations (federal/state inmates estimated at \$1.2 million for 2025) were incorporated to offset anticipated expenditure deficits.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:**
 - **03:09:01 Tony** (Sheriff Department) spoke at the podium regarding jail revenue numbers, confirming comfort with projecting \$1.2 million in federal/state inmate revenue for 2025 based on recent monthly averages of roughly \$140,000.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Review and adjustments accepted and recorded into working spreadsheets. Final reconciliation scheduled for an upcoming Wednesday

work session at 3:30 PM prior to DLGF submission deadlines.

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

Note: The meeting was structured as an internal council and department head budget work session; no general public citizen forum took place.

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - The council scheduled a follow-up budget review and final reconciliation meeting for **Wednesday at 3:30 PM** to finalize Motor Vehicle Highway (MVH) numbers with the auditor's office and review prosecutor experience matrix details.
 - Department heads (including Tony from the Sheriff's office) agreed to provide detailed monthly billing and accounts receivable breakdowns to assist with cash flow projections.
 - **Adjournment:** The meeting concluded following scheduling announcements for Wednesday's session [HH:MM:SS timestamp not explicitly finalized as a formal motion, concluding at [03:48:49](#)].
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